The Era of She-Ra

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45962254.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Categories:
F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Alternate Universe, Post-Canon, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Post-War, Temporary Character Death, Near Death Experiences, Catra (She-Ra) Redemption, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Hurt Adora (She-Ra), Hurt/Comfort, Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Recovery, Injury Recovery, Adora Needs To Relax, Catra is a Soft Girlfriend, Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Minor Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra & Glimmer Friendship (She-Ra), Family Fluff, Fluff and Angst, Domestic Fluff

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English

Series:
Part 1 of After the War

Stats:
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The Era of She-Ra

by AstrynSerene

Summary

Cast out the shadows. Bring the universe to Prime's light.

Cast out the shadows. Bring the universe to Prime's light.

"The Heart of Etheria…"
"...I'm sorry…"

"Adora! Adora!!"
"Don't you get it?! I love you! I always have! So please, just this once, stay!" She cried, burying her face in the crook of her shoulder, "Stay…"

"You love me..?" The blonde gasped, looking up at the magicat with wide eyes that forced a laugh out of her.

"You're such an idiot." She mused, only for her own eyes to widen at the fond expression of pure love Adora was giving her.

"I love you too…"

That was enough. Catra smiled warmly, cupping Adora's face as she leaned in, their lips crashing together in a fiery passion as the Failsafe finally fully activated, surrounding the couple with magic as it blasted it's way out of the Heart and back to Etheria where it belonged. And for a moment, everything was perfect. Catra loved Adora, and Adora loved Catra. They were finally sharing their long overdue first kiss as Etheria was returned to the magical being it should have always been, taking Prime out and ending the war that should have never been.

Then that moment ended.

Notes

I cried a LOT when I wrote the start of this story, thus I made it my mission to make everyone who reads it cry as well, Enjoy!! :D

Don't worry though, much lighter chapters and fluff follow later! <3

See the end of the work for more notes

Sorrows of the Heart

Cast out the shadows. Bring the universe to Prime's light.

Cast out the shadows. Bring the universe to Prime's light.

Cast out the shadows. Bring the universe to Prime's light!

The endless chanting of the clones was becoming too much for Catra's ears. Her eyes widened as the large green probe lowered into the ground, connecting to the planet and sending a surge of Prime's Virus throughout Etheria.

"Adora…" The magicat breathed, clinging to Melog, "W-We have to warn Adora!" She cried, tears of panic running down her face as her companion began to race back towards the camp as fast as their legs would carry them.

' *Do not worry, kit. We'll find your mate. I promise.* '

Melog's words were slightly assuring, but the rising panic in Catra's chest and bile in her throat refused to waver until she regained sight of the blonde.

It took around ten minutes to reach the hidden camp, and Catra wasted no time leaping off of Melog and racing inside, "Adora?!"

She cried, panting as she skidded to a stop in the near empty room, "A-Adora!"

"She's not here."

The brunette glared at the sorceress lounging against some crates, an empty wine glass in hand, "What do you mean she's not here? Where is she?!"

Shadow Weaver sighed, dropping the cup and getting to her feet to approach the younger woman, "She's gone to the Heart of Etheria to free the magic and become the hero she was born to be. If you are still so selfish as to try and stop–"

"Enough!" Catra cried, grabbing the scarf around Shadow Weaver's shoulders, pulling her down to face her, "This isn't about you and your messed-up power trip anymore. Prime is doing something to the Heart- He's.. *infecting* it! He's going for the Heart!"

"That is *precisely why* Adora must reach the Heart, Catra! She's going to stop him from taking it. What part of that do you not understand?"

"What part of 'he's going for the Heart and he's going to stop and kill Adora in the process' do *you* not understand, you old witch! Stop being so *stubborn* and acting like Adora is invincible! Her

holding that cursed Failsafe is going to mean *nothing* if she isn't able to deploy it!"

Before Shadow Weaver could come up with a response, Prime's voice echoed across the planet outside.

" *Rejoice, Etheria, for your day of reckoning has come. I offered you mercy. But you have spurned my good graces. So be it.* "

Catra and Shadow Weaver raced outside just as Prime held up a bound Entrapta by her pigtails. The scientist only managed to whimper a small, "I'm sorry..!"

" *Your resistance has been for naught. Your She-Ra has abandoned you. All that is left for your world is a terrible and eternal night.* "

Eyes wide, now equally as full of rage as they were fear, the magicat glared up at the sorceress, "Take us to Adora. Now!"

"She's too far away by now. We'd never reach her in time."

Catra narrowed her eyes, "No! Use your magic. I know you have more power than you're letting on."

"It doesn't work that way, Catra!"

"You've done it before! Wh-when you abandoned me in the Fright Zone. And you've always been able to track us our whole lives. So, *do something good with it for once* and help me save Adora before it's too late!" The brunette spat, glaring daggers at her former caretaker, who, for her part, remained silent for a moment before reaching into a pocket of her robe and pulling out a small container. A strange blue powder was sitting inside.

"Come here." She said simply, extending a hand. Tentatively, Catra took it, closing her eyes as they were engulfed in magic, disappearing from the Whispering Woods in a matter of moments.

⚔

Catra gasped when they appeared in the halls leading to the Heart of Etheria. Completely disregarding Shadow Weaver as she groaned and fell against the wall, she rushed over to a weeping Bow and Glimmer, "Where's Adora?" She asked, frantic hands grasping the queen's shoulders.

"She.. She left us! She's headed to the Heart on her own!" Glimmer gasped, tears trickling down her cheeks.

Catra scoffed, "Of- course she's gone! That's what she does- isn't it?!"

"Catra.. What's going on?" Bow asked after a concerning rumble was heard above them.

"Horde Prime is onto you. He's hacking into the planet all.. All of this is from him!" She explained, gesturing to the green virus lining the surrounding walls and floors.

"He's gonna take the Heart..!"

"That's not all. He's got Entrapta."

Bow gasped, "If Prime has Entrapta.. That means the other princesses are still chipped. We have to get back up there."

"We can't just leave Adora!" Glimmer reasoned.

"I'll stay." Catra interrupted, clenching her fists at her sides, "I'll find her."

"Catra-"

"-I can't lose her again, okay!?" Tears threatening to well up, Catra pressed her nails to her palms, ".. I promised her a long

time ago that I'd look out for her. It's time I made good on that."

Smiling knowingly, Glimmer slowly approached, before embracing Catra gently yet firmly, "Take care of her.. Horde Scum."

A breath of a laugh escaped as Catra returned the hug, "That's the plan, Sparkles. And, good luck." She added as she pulled away.

"The four of us don't need luck," Bow prompted, wrapping his arms around both women, "We're the Best Friend Squad."

Smiling warmly, Catra leaned into the embrace momentarily before moving to crouch in front of Melog, "Get them there safe. 'Kay?" She whispered.

' *I will, kit. I'll see you soon, now go find your mate.* ' Melog mewled, licking the brunette's cheek before walking over and curling around Bow and Glimmer. The three shared warm smiles before Glimmer teleported out of the Heart, Bow and Melog at her sides.

Taking a deep breath, Catra turned to face Shadow Weaver, who seemed to finally have gotten herself together, "You know about this place. Any idea where the Heart is?" She questioned, assuming that's where Adora should be heading as well.

Nodding, Shadow Weaver took the lead, and the two raced down the corridor, desperately searching for Adora.

⚔

The next ten minutes or so were a complete blur for Catra. Upon finding Adora they were met with some old First One's monster attacking her. On instinct, she took it on, demanding that Shadow Weaver get Adora to the Heart, promising to catch up.

Unfortunately, before she too could find an escape, the creature managed to grab her with Prime's intimidation.

" *So brave, risking yourself for Adora. But it will make no difference. The Heart is almost mine, and when it is, your Adora will die.. So tell me, Little Sister, was it worth it?* "

Just as she braced herself for a bitter end, she was saved by the woman who'd arguably done the most damage to her throughout her life.

"Shadow Weaver?" She gasped after recovering from a rough crash to the floor.

"Take Adora and run!" Was the only reply she got as the sorceress launched an attack at the creature with her magic.

"What are you..?"

"I told you to run. Now *run* !" Shadow Weaver snapped, using her powers to throw Catra down the corridor before sealing it with a barrier.

Panic coursed through her veins, and her instincts had her pounding her fist against the barrier, "Shadow Weaver, no! What are you doing?!"

" *Please* , Catra. You need to make sure Adora reaches the Heart. The magic must be set free!" Shadow Weaver was.. pleading with her. Tears ran down Catra's face as she watched the losing battle helplessly.

"Stop it, it's going to kill you!!" She tried again, gasping for breath.

"It's too late for me. But you, this is only the beginning for you. I am so proud of you, Catra." Her words hit Catra right in the chest. Her lip quivered.

"No! No!!" She cried, raising a hand to pound on the barrier again, only to be stopped by her hand being grabbed.

"Catra?" Adora's voice was enough to pull her attention away from the fight, even if it was momentarily.

The two turned back together just as Shadow Weaver removed and dropped her mask. She breathed a simple, "You're welcome," before turning towards the creature and releasing a final surge of her power. It was enough to destroy the monster, but it took her with it.

Adora fell to her knees, sobbing as she covered her mouth with a hand. Catra stood in disbelief as the barrier finally faded away. She knew they didn't have time to grieve however, and wiped her eyes, "Come on…" she whispered, a gentle hand placed on the blonde's shoulder, "We have to go." She helped Adora to her feet, the two sharing an embrace before helping each other down the corridor, determined to get to the Heart and end the war, once and for all.

⚔

The trip down the long corridor brought back many memories for the two. Some good, some bad, but all of times they were together. Now, they stood side by side, not on opposite sides of the war, not as enemies, or soldiers of the Rebellion, but together, smiling at each other as they were held in the other's supportive embrace.

"The Heart of Etheria…" Adora gasped when they reached the end of the tunnel, and were left underneath what was capable of wiping out the universe, "We made it."

Catra gave Adora's arm a final squeeze before she let go, and allowed her to step forward to transform and activate the Failsafe..

Except she didn't transform. Adora walked forward and held out her arm, only to cry out in pain and stumble back into Catra's arms.

"What is it? What's wrong?" The brunette asked quickly, fear coating her eyes.

"I don't… I don't know. I can't transform!"

"What does that mean? Is the Failsafe not going to work without her?"

All seemed to fall silent for a moment as the glow of the Failsafe radiated from Adora's chest. Her worst fears now confirmed, the blonde sighed, "No.. It'll work.." She took a deep breath before looking up at the Heart, "Get as far away from here as you can. I need to do this next part on my own."

"Adora.." Catra narrowed her eyes, "What is going to happen to you?"

"Without She-Ra.. t-the magic will destroy me.." Adora slowly admitted, tears running down her face, "I'm sorry, Catra… I'm so sorry!" She gasped, approaching slowly, "But there's no more time. It has to end here. I can still save everybody!" She gently cupped the magicat's face, "It's okay… I'm ready…" Voice now a mere whisper, she slowly pulled away, only for Catra to grab her hands.

"No."

"C-Catra..!"

"No. I'm not leaving! Whatever happens I am staying with you!"

Nodding, Adora turned back towards the Heart, relaxing slightly at the feeling of Catra grabbing her arm. She took a final breath before letting her eyes slide closed as the Failsafe activated.

Gasping, Adora's legs buckled as she collapsed, Catra catching her and cradling her close, "Adora?" Catra's eyes widened when the blonde only cried out in pain, "No, no, no, no, no. No! No!" She carefully turned Adora onto her back, letting her rest in her lap, "Adora. Adora, stay awake!"

"...I'm sorry…" Adora whispered, her eyelids growing heavier as she faded from consciousness.

"Adora! Adora!!" Catra cried, hugging Adora close to her. Her heart rate picked up when the blonde's hand slid from her own, "Adora please…!" She whimpered, holding her as securely as she possibly could. She gasped when another crash and rumble was heard above them, but didn't dare move from her spot shielding the princess, "I need you, Adora…" she gasped, unable to hold herself together.

Another loud crash was enough to trigger Catra once more, "Adora please! You have to wake up! You can't give up, you.. you have never given up on anything in your life. Not even on *me* ." She was begging now, pleading to the universe to let Adora open her eyes, "So don't you dare start now! I've gotchu, and I'm not letting go! Don't…" a blush lined her face, but the confession about to spill from her lips might never fall on Adora's ears if she doesn't say it now, "Don't you get it?! I love you! I always have! So please, just this once, *stay* !" She cried, burying her face in the crook of her shoulder, "Stay…"

A sudden crash mere inches above them forced Catra to look up, only to see Adora holding up a shield to protect them from the debris. She looked back as the shield dematerialized and Adora's hand landed on her shoulder.

"You love me..?" The blonde gasped, looking up at the magicat with wide eyes that forced a laugh out of her.

"You're such an idiot." She mused, only for her own eyes to widen at the fond expression of pure love Adora was giving her.

"I love you too…"

That was enough. Catra smiled warmly, cupping Adora's face as she leaned in, their lips crashing together in a fiery passion as the Failsafe finally fully activated, surrounding the couple with magic as it blasted it's way out of the Heart and back to Etheria where it belonged. And for a moment, everything was perfect. Catra loved Adora, and Adora loved Catra. They were finally sharing their long overdue first kiss as Etheria was returned to the magical being it should have always been, taking Prime out and ending the war that should have never been.

Then that moment ended.

The feeling of Adora returning their embrace faded, as did all sound in the Heart. Catra's ears perked up as she slowly pulled away, "Wow..-" She opened her eyes, only for them to widen, "A-Adora?" She looked up and realized all light and magic had faded from the Heart, along with the sound of the heartbeat that accompanied it. That couldn't have been Adora's..

The silence was deafening.

Frantically, Catra shook the blonde by her shoulders, only to receive no response, "Adora!!" She cried out, pressing her ear to her chest in a desperate search for her heartbeat.. only to find none, "No! No, NO!" She gasped, nearly choking on her breath as she broke down fully, "You have to be okay! You- you did it! Everything is okay now! Please, Adora! I can't..! I need you!" She

was on the verge of a panic attack as she cradled her lover's lifeless body.

When she still received no response, Catra didn't know what else to do, so she screamed. She screamed as loud as her voice would carry. She didn't care that her voice cracked, or that half of Etheria could probably hear her. She had everything, and now it was gone. Losing Adora meant losing everything that gave her life purpose and meaning. She was now lost. She let out another scream of pure pain and grief, laying her forehead against Adora's as she continued to openly sob for her lost love.

"Adora! Catra!" Glimmer's sudden cheerful voice did nothing to make Catra move as she heard footsteps approaching behind her, "She did it! He's gone! It's over she-" the queen froze in her tracks, eyes widening when she saw the scene in front of her, "C-Catra..?"

"W-What.. How..?" Bow managed, both of them reduced to tears as they collapsed on either side of the magicat.

"I- I don't know! We.. I t-told her I loved her and we k-kissed and when I pulled away she…" Catra gasped for breath, "She… she can't be… she has to be okay..!"

Glimmer gingerly reached out and ran a hand through Adora's hair, not ready to accept the tragedy yet herself, "She told us it would always end here when she left us to come here alone… She knew this would happen and didn't want us to witness it…"

"She didn't deserve to be alone like that… thank you for being here, Catra…" Bow whimpered, wrapping his arms loosely around the magicat, who sobbed openly into his shirt, still cradling Adora.

"We… we should bring her home… let her rest in her room for a little w-while…" Glimmer had to pause to try and regain some of her composure before she broke down again. She wanted to be strong for Bow and Catra, despite knowing she didn't need to.

Nodding, Bow rubbed Catra's back as the queen teleported the group out of the Heart of Etheria and back to the palace in Brightmoon.

⚔

Catra stared at Adora with a broken expression. She had yet to show signs of stopping her tears, her shaky hand gripping onto the blonde's as she rested in her bed.

They had laid her against a few pillows, a blanket draped delicately up to her abdomen. She looked so peaceful, like she was taking the much deserved nap she'd needed her entire life.

"I'm so sorry, Adora…" She whispered, her tender touch bringing Adora's hand to her lips, where she pressed a gentle kiss to her

knuckles, "You don't deserve this… you deserve a beautiful life without all the responsibility of being the perfect hero… you deserve better than me… I hurt you so much, when I should have been showing you how much I l-love you…"

"Catra..?"

The magicat glanced behind her to see Bow standing in the doorway, "Glimmer and I decided to keep this all between us for today… that way we can all have some time with her. Do you need anything..? Water?"

Shaking her head, Catra looked back at Adora, her ears pressed tightly against her head, "Not for me. Maybe something for Melog though…" she managed, motioning to her companion, who was curled up sadly next to the chair she was sitting in.

"Sure thing…" Sighing, Bow closed the door before heading off to the kitchen.

The silence of the room only lasted a few moments before Catra began sobbing again. Carefully, she got to her feet and leaned over the blonde, "I love you so much, my beautiful princess…" she whispered, "I hope you're getting the rest you more than deserve…" She leaned down, kissing her with a gentle passion she'd longed for her entire life.

With her eyes closed, she didn't notice the soft golden glow of magic illuminating between her chest and Adora's, emitting from the scar of the Failsafe. She didn't realize that her heartbeat had returned.

Slowly, she pulled away, and sat back in her seat, wiping her eyes. She knew the other two would want a few moments with Adora too, but she wasn't planning to leave Adora's side, no matter what. She grasped her hand once more, laying her head down on the bed, just as Adora started to open her eyes.

A Beautiful Wish

Chapter Summary

Adora is awake, and the others couldn't be happier

Chapter Notes

Here's your fluff chapter you gremlins! XD

Next chapter will be a mix of both angst and fluff >:)

" *A beautiful wish, but there will be no future. Not for you.* "

" *Adora, please! You have to wake up!!* "

The vision of her perfect future was a dream Adora wanted to cherish, especially in her inevitable final moments.

" *Don't you get it? I love you! I always have! So please just this once, stay!* "

" *You love me..?* "

" *You're such an idiot..* "

" *.. I love you too.* "

The kiss she shared with Catra was euphoric, and one she was grateful for as she slowly slipped away in her lover's arms.

⚔

The taste of Catra's lips against her own was the first thing she felt when she began to wake once more. It was odd, as she wasn't sure how much time had passed- or how she was even alive. All she knew was that she was no longer at the Heart of Etheria. She felt Catra's hand squeezing her own as her eyes slowly fluttered open. It only took her a few seconds to realize she was back in her bed in Brightmoon. She glanced over realizing Catra was crying, and instinctively gave her hand a comforting squeeze.

The reaction was immediate. Catra jerked to a sitting position, eyes wide as she looked at Adora, "Adora?!" She gasped.

"C-Cat…-" Adora managed before the brunette suddenly cupped her face and showered her with kisses.

"Oh my stars you're- how?! Fuck, I don't care, you're *okay* !" Tears ran down her face, this time though they were of happiness as she continued the plethora of kisses.

Giggling, Adora smiled up at the magicat as she crashed their lips together, "What happened..?" The blonde asked once she'd pulled away from the kiss, her face flushed red from all the new affection.

A gentle smile formed on Catra's face as she tenderly cupped Adora's cheek, "You saved Etheria, that's what, dummy."

"He's.. gone?"

"Yup, he's gone. Now you can rest."

Nodding, Adora started to shift to sit up, only to cry out in pain. Catra was immediately at her side, guiding her to lay back down, "Hey hey.. You've been through way too much, don't try anything strenuous."

"Mm… I.. I want…" Adora trailed off.

Ears perking up, Catra squeezed her hand, "What do you want, Adora..?" She whispered, her voice laced with as much care as she could offer. It was a tone reserved only for Adora, one the blonde had missed so much.

"You to.. h-hold me…"

Smiling, the magicat slipped into the bed and wrapped her arms around the blonde, letting her snuggle into her embrace.

Whimpering, Adora rested her head on Catra's chest, "Everything h-hurts…"

"I know, I know… just relax, I've got you…"

The door opened moments later, Bow entering with a few bottles of water and a pet bowl, "I know you said no, but I just thought-" His eyes widened as he dropped what he was holding, causing Adora to flinch.

"Uhh, Bow..?" Adora raised an eyebrow.

The archer was at the bedside in seconds, gently wrapping his arms around both Catra and Adora, "You're alive! Oh my gosh I'm so happy you're okay!" He cried, smiling.

"A-alive?" Panic glazed Adora's eyes, "Does that mean I…"

The glare from Catra was enough for Bow to back off and sit on the edge of the bed, "You…uhm.."

"You took a lot from the Heart, Adora. You.. gave us a real scare and for a moment we thought you.." Catra took a deep breath, cupping Adora's face and kissing her gently. The calming effects were instantaneous, "You're okay now, and that's all that matters."

"Yyyyup! Exactly! Oh!" Getting up, Bow quickly gathered the bottles of water and bowl, which he sat against the wall and filled with water for Melog before setting the rest on the bedside table, "I'm glad I brought several, you both need it."

"Thanks, Bow." Catra smiled, "Also, you should probably go tell Sparkles what uh.. happened."

"Right! Expect a teleportation in about three minutes!" He exclaimed as he hurried out of the room.

Adora smiled when Catra grabbed a water bottle and opened it, before holding it up to her, "Thank you…" She moved to take it before Catra held her arm down.

"Nu-uh, let me."

While blushing furiously, she nodded and leaned against Catra, allowing her to hold the bottle while she drank. As her eyes drifted closed and her body relaxed. She drank a little over half the bottle before she felt the it pull away, "I love you, Catra…" she whispered.

"I love you too, Adora." The magicat smiled, kissing the top of her head. She knew the recovery the blonde was facing wasn't going to be easy, but she was going to do whatever it took to make sure she stayed in bed and healed.

Of course, reunions were clearly in order, and despite Bow's warning, Catra still jumped when he and Glimmer teleported into the room moments later, "Adora!" Glimmer cried, hugging her, and by extension Catra, gently, "You did it, and now you're okay!" She pressed a kiss to her cheek.

"Gah! You three are gonna kill me again with all the affection!" Adora joked, giggling, but she was tearing up herself.

"We just love you, Adora. Imagining you not being here now is…" Bow blinked back tears again, though they fell seconds later, wiping Adora's tears away with his thumb, "If anyone deserves this happy ending, it's you."

Unable to find the words to respond, the princess simply nodded, relaxing as Glimmer and Bow made themselves comfortable on either side of her and Catra, "We are definitely having a Best Friend's Squad sleepover tonight. Queen's orders!" Glimmer sniffed, now unable to keep the smile off of her face that just half an hour ago seemed forever lost.

"I'd- really like that," Adora hummed, "As much as I know I'm gonna hate it I.. I'm not leaving this bed for a while. Not without

assistance."

"The Heart really messed you up…" Bow whimpered.

"It's that but- stars I'm so exhausted.." Adora blushed, feeling a weight being lifted from her chest with the confession.

"Trust us, princess, we're making sure you rest for a month at the very least." Catra said, running a hand through Adora's hair.

Again, the blonde could only nod as a response. She wondered if there would always be a part of her that would reject the need and want for a life outside of the perfect soldier she was raised to be.

Yawning, she pushed those thoughts away for the moment, the warmth of Catra's embrace too enticing for her to think about much else. Smiling, Adora nuzzled her face against Catra's shoulder after carefully rolling onto her side.

The others yawned themselves not long after, all cuddling up together on the bed. It only took a few minutes of comfortable silence for the squad to fall asleep, hearts thankfully no longer having a piece missing.

Rest & Relaxation

Chapter Summary

> It's been a week since the events of the Heart. Adora and Catra have started therapy, but they're mainly just trying to rest after being driven to exhaustion.

Chapter Notes

> A little fluff, a little angst. Next week's chapter will be very fluff and romantic, not quite princess prom, but still a party, just for Adora <3

The world around Adora was nothing but the literal coffin she had been buried in. Her breath picked up, laced in panic, tears staining her cheeks as she slammed her fists against the door above her. She screamed, crying, begging *for someone to hear and save her. She felt her consciousness slowly slipping away along with the fading oxygen, Prime's mock laughter filling her ears…*

Adora's screams filled the room as she jerked to a sitting position, sending their blanket flying off to the floor.

Catra was awake and at her lover's side in seconds, gentle hands on her shoulders, "It's okay, it's okay, just breathe… it was just a nightmare…"

Whining, the blonde turned and clung to her girlfriend, grateful to lay back down in the safety of her arms, "It- it felt so real! I- I was trapped under-.. you all thought I was-!"

"Shh, baby…" Catra kissed the top of her head, holding her close, "I promise that would never happen…"

Ever since that day at the Heart a week ago, Adora's mind had been plagued with nightmares that kept her awake every night, "I- I'm sorry…"

"Adora, you have nothing to apologize for, okay? It's completely okay to be scared. I've gotchu, and I'm not letting go, okay..?"

"Okay…" Adora took a deep breath, burying her face in Catra's shoulder, slowly calming down, "Catra..?"

"Yes, Adora?"

"I love you…"

"I love you too, princess." Catra smiled, blushing as she kissed the top of Adora's head, "Think you can go back to sleep?" She prompted, noticing she'd calmed down significantly.

"M-Mhm.. Just- hold me?"

"Of course, princess." Catra replied, a loving smile on her face to match her caring tone. Melog mewled as they hopped onto the

bed, blanket in mouth as they dragged it back to their companions' reach, "Thank you, buddy." Catra hummed, giving them little scratches behind their ears before curling back up with Adora under the covers.

⚔

While nights were hard on Adora, the days could be either considerably better, or worse, depending on how she felt physically. Two weeks into recovery, she was curled up in Catra's arms, listening to her read, eyes closed. Over the past couple of weeks, she'd been on strict bedrest, not that she could get very far anyway. The Heart had taken all of her energy and strength, and she felt like she hadn't slept in two years.

"Hey, Catra..?"

Pausing her reading, the magicat looked down at Adora, "Yeah?"

"I.. I never properly thanked you…"

"Uh," Catra raised an eyebrow, "For what?" She bookmarked the page she was on before setting the book down.

"For saving my life…" Adora's gaze was downcast as she fidgeted with the blanket.

"What do you mean..?"

"It took me a week to really figure things out, but your- your kiss brought me back." She had wanted to say *love* , but she didn't want to push Catra, "I had given up… I knew the Failsafe was going to kill me, and I had accepted it. I knew it was selfish, even more so that I let you stay there with me-"

"-Adora." Catra interrupted, cupping her cheek, "I wasn't leaving. Nothing you said or did in that moment was gonna change that. And it's not selfish to want comfort when you're that scared and in pain."

"Well- still. That's- not even where I was going with this." Catra furrowed her eyebrows. She reminded herself that Adora would need lots of time and help to fully accept and voice her wants and needs. So, she remained silent to let her finish, "My point was that it wasn't my want to save the universe that brought me back. It was my want and need for you. When I was… asleep, I had this- vision, or dream, about my perfect future.. a wish I knew I could never have."

"You did?" Catra's ears perked up in interest, "Can you tell me about it..?"

"Well…" Adora blushed, "I was in this room, though it had been renovated, wearing this white and gold dress, alone until you came running up to me. Glimmer was chasing you with a

hairbrush demanding to let her brush it," A fond smile grew on her face, "Both of you circled me a couple times before Bow walked in, saying we'd be late for Scorpia's first princess prom if we didn't hurry. Glimmer and Bow left and you started to follow, before looking at me. You asked if I was coming and held your hand out to me…"

"Mhm?" Catra's eyes were dilated, tail wagging gently. She squeezed Adora's hand.

"I went to take your hand but- then Prime showed up, telling me that it was a beautiful wish, b-but there wouldn't be a future for me. Then this light- I thought it was She-Ra's magic, and I guess maybe it was partially, flooded in and destroyed him, before I woke up to you kissing me."

"Wow- I…"

"Was it too much? I'm sorry I shouldn't have-"

"No no! It's okay, Adora!" Catra chuckled, bringing Adora's hand to her lips and pressing a gentle kiss to her knuckles, "I just- I love you too, you goof."

Laughing, Adora curled up a little more, pulling her legs up to be covered completely by both her nightgown, and the blanket, "That, and again, thank you. I wouldn't be here right now without you."

"I could say the same thing to you." Catra mused, brushing a stray hair out of Adora's face, "By the way, we both have our second sessions with Perfuma tomorrow. Mine is in the morning, and yours is in the afternoon."

"Surprised that it isn't reversed," Adora snorted.

"Yeah, well you need to sleep, and it'll be easier to get there for you if I'm not out cold."

"Brightmoon cushions have already ruined you huh?"

"Shut up!" The two laughed, cuddling a little closer once they calmed down.

"I love you.."

"I love you too, Adora." Catra kissed the top of her head, "Wanna get back to the book?"

Eyes lighting up, Adora quickly nodded.

⚔

Adora took a deep breath, leaning back in her wheelchair. She'd taken a liking to having her therapy sessions in the garden, but had to compromise by using a wheelchair to get around for the time being. She wasn't complaining though, not really. Her legs burned every time she tried to stand up, like all the exercise and battles she'd ever been through suddenly caught up with her.

"So how have your nightmares been?"

"Mm, rough. They're always the same though. It's either Prime winning and taking Catra from me or- being…you know.. waking up in a grave, but Catra always helps me calm down."

"Have you tried the breathing techniques I taught you last time?"

"Mhm! They helped, granted Catra had to guide me through it, but…"

"That's okay! You can't be expected to guide yourself through a moment of panic like that so quickly."

"Heh, I did use them to help Catra calm down after she had a bad dream though."

"I know, she told me, and I'm very proud of both of you. Two sessions in and you're already practicing proper coping skills!" Perfuma smiled, placing a hand on Adora's shoulder, "I know you and Catra help each other a lot, and that's wonderful, but there's some things I'd like you to do independently as well." Reaching into her satchel, she pulled out a leather bound journal, passing it to Adora, "I want you to use this everyday. I don't care if you write down a list of things you're grateful for, vent, just a daily mood check in, or a dream journal. Just write something down. That way you can look back on it when you need to. You can choose to share it with me at our sessions or keep it private, but I won't ask you to. That'll be entirely your decision."

"Okay.." Adora placed the book in her lap.

"We've been here almost two hours now, if you wanna end the session for the day?"

"Yeah- that's probably a good idea," Adora chuckled. They'd spent an hour and a half just talking about what was going through Adora's head while at the Heart, what she was feeling and wanted. Adora had requested to work backwards, instead of jumping straight into her mess of a childhood and Shadow Weaver's.. 'parenting'.

Nodding, Perfuma stood from the bench she was on, before starting to push Adora's wheelchair back inside, "I'm sorry you're so hurt and exhausted from the Heart, by the way, but I am glad you're taking all this time to relax and properly recover. It's healthy for both your mind and body."

"I've noticed. I'm still restless in bed or my chair after so long, but I guess I've always just been fidgety."

"I understand, and that's alright. Maybe you should try to find a hobby that will let you move around a bit without straining yourself."

"I'm trying, but so far the only thing I've liked is doing gentle stretches with Catra."

"That works! Maybe try some yoga if you can find some comfortable position."

"I'll definitely look into it." Adora hummed, smiling when Catra opened the bedroom door before they were even within twenty feet of the door.

"Hey, Adora. Hey, Perfuma. How was the session?"

"Progress was made." Perfume said, wheeling Adora into the room and over to the bed before stepping away and changing the subject, "Are you two coming to the ball tomorrow night?"

"Yeah, we couldn't let the guest of honor be stuck in bed the whole time," Catra winked, flustering Adora, who looked away, embarrassed, "But yes, we'll be there. I actually just got back

from picking up our outfits. Glimmer insisted we have something tailored."

"Well, I can't wait. I'll see you two tomorrow night!" Perfuma waved, before stepping out and closing the door gently behind her.

"Guest of honor? Really?" Adora raised an eyebrow as Catra helped her back into the bed.

"Yyyup!" The brunette replied, popping the 'p' as she carefully removed Adora's boots, "Sparkles, Bow, and I decided the ball would be in your honor since you saved the universe."

"Well- I couldn't have done it without you or them!"

"Shhh, just let this be about you, princess." Catra set the boots on the floor before curling up next to Adora, hugging her close. She had a hard time letting Adora out of her sight at the moment, afraid that she would find Adora dead again if she was gone too long. Thank goodness for Perfuma, "Speaking of the ball, wanna go help decorate the ballroom after dinner?"

"I'd love to! But I'm not sure what all I can do in a wheelchair.."

"Just because She-Ra can't hang streamers doesn't mean you can't help, dork. There's plenty you can help with. I do think we

have time for a nap before dinner though…"

Adora giggled before yawning, "Yeah, actually that does sound nice.."

"Naptime it is then! Melog!"

The alien feline looked up from their spot on the balcony, running in and leaping up onto the bed. They meowed, giving both Catra and her mate a lick on the cheek before settling down for a cuddle session and afternoon nap.

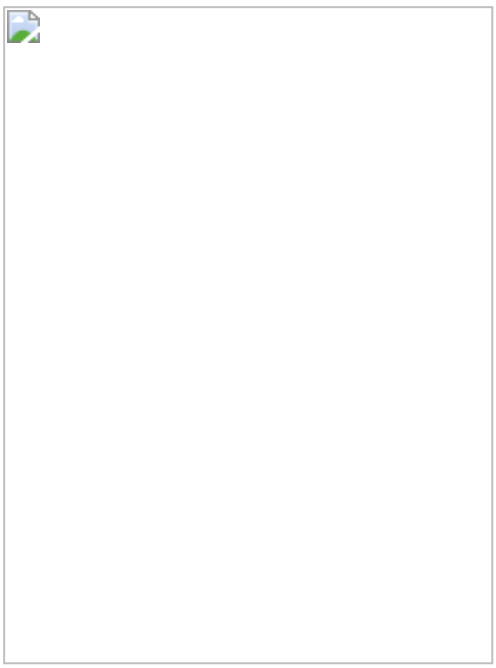
In Honor of Adora

Chapter Summary

The squad throws a ball for Adora to commemorate all she did during the war.

Chapter Notes

My friend Blu made these adorable doodles of wheelchair Adora and I HAD to share!! Thank you again!!!



Adora gasped, biting her lip as Catra gently bent her leg, before lowering it back down, "You okay?"

"M-mhm! Just- give me a second..!"

Frowning, Catra moved up next to the blonde, taking her hand, "We've been at this for ten minutes, I think that's enough for today. You made some progress! Yesterday you couldn't even lift your knee a few inches off the bed."

Pouting, Adora squeezed Catra's hand, "I hate being stuck in here..."

"I know, but at least you'll be out tonight for the ball." Catra offered, laying her tail over Adora's hands, which the blonde immediately began to fidget with.

"A ball that I can't do anything at."

"Oh, yes you can. You'll have fun, I promise."

Nodding, Adora took a deep breath, "Can you help me sit up?" She asked after a moment, finally letting go of Catra's tail as her attention shifted.

Carefully, Catra wrapped her arms around Adora and pulled her into a sitting position, only for Adora to cling to her in a hug, "What's this for?"

"Just because I love you.."

"Tch, idiot." Catra blushed, placing her hand on the small of Adora's back. She held her for a few minutes before pulling back enough to face her, "You know you still haven't seen the outfits I got us from the tailors."

Blushing, Adora nodded, "Can I see them now?"

"Of course," Catra chuckled. She carefully untangled herself from Adora, leaving her sitting on the bed as she retrieved the dress and suit from the closet. Adora's dress was a white spaghetti strap gown with a golden belt, small gold tiara, and golden sandals to match. Catra's suit was strikingly similar to her one from Princess Prom, only this time it was white with gold accents instead of magenta and burgundy.

Adora's eyes lit up at the matching outfits, "They're beautiful, Catra!"

"Glad you like them. I wanted it to be a little surprise, so I gave Glimmer my measurements since the tailor already had yours, and then a sketch of what I wanted so I could stay home with you."

Catra calling Brightmoon 'home' warmed her heart, something she didn't think she'd ever hear, "Brightmoon is your home now..?"

"Gh-" Red in the face, Catra shrugged, "I guess. Only cause you're here though."

"Awe!" Adora pouted, holding her arms out to Catra, who playfully rolled her eyes, hanging the outfits back in the closet before returning to the bed, pulling Adora into a hug and kissing her gently, "I love you…"

"I love you too, dummy. Now let's get some lunch and start getting ready for the party."

⚔

Of all the things Adora was expecting when it came to the party, it wasn't for everyone to cheer for her the second Catra wheeled her into the ballroom. Her entire face flushed red at the entourage of attention.

"Guys… You *really* didn't have to do all this. I didn't do this alone." Adora whined when she was brought to Glimmer and Bow.

"Hey, you've done nothing but work and fight your entire life, expecting nothing and feeling like you have to be the best. This is the absolute least of all you deserve." Glimmer smiled, leaning down to hug Adora, "We know you'll never accept the full credit, but tonight is about celebrating all the things you did do. Okay?" She pulled back, glad to see a sheepish smile on her friend's face.

"Okay.. Thank you. All of you."

Nodding, Bow looked over in time to see Micah approaching, setting a tray of drinks on the table they were near, "Here you guys go. I figured you all wanted to stick together tonight."

"Thank you, dad." Glimmer hummed, giving him a hug before Castaspella stole his attention.

"Adora!"

The blonde turned her head when Perfuma approached the group, "You look beautiful! How are you feeling?"

"A bit better, actually. We're still meeting tomorrow right?"

"Of course! I'm happy to see you're making progress. All of you, actually."

Catra purred quietly, her hand resting on Adora's shoulder.

"Well, I was actually heading to find Scorpia," Perfuma added, heat growing in her cheeks, "But I wanted to say hi on my way."

She waved before making her way to find the scorpioni princess.

⚔

The Best Friend Squad spent an hour just making small talk and taking the time to relax in the first non threatening atmosphere they'd experienced in a long time, before Bow finally asked Glimmer to a dance, and the two stepped away from the table.

Adora watched them for a moment, frowning slightly. She was happy for them, she just wished she could have…

"May I have this dance, princess?"

Adora looked up to see Catra offering her hand and an only slightly smirky smile, "I'd love to, Catra, but I can't.." She motioned to herself and the wheelchair.

"Sure you can. Trust me?"

"Of course I do."

Catra nodded, before wrapping her arms around Adora and lifting her into her arms, letting the latter wrap her arms around her shoulders while keeping her arms under Adora's bottom.

"Oh- Catra you don't have to-"

"-I *want* to, princess," Catra smiled, stepping a little bit away from the wheelchair, but still giving them their own space just off the dancefloor.

Smiling now, Adora simply nodded, giggling as Catra gently swayed them with the music. Tears threatened to well up in Adora's eyes, but she blinked them away as she focused on the beautiful moment she was given. She pressed a kiss to Catra's cheek before resting her forehead against Catra's, "Thank you…" she whispered after a moment.

"Anything for you…" Catra returned, just as quiet, before turning in an attempt to imitate twirling Adora. It was clumsy, but it had the latter laughing all the same.

⚔

Bow was the first to notice the couple, and nearly squealed with joy, "Glimmer..! Look..!" He managed, getting the queen's attention as she was pulled up from a dip.

"Hm- Oh my stars..!" Glimmer gasped, seeing Catra holding Adora, dancing slowly along with the music, "I need a trackerpad, now!"

With two teleports, Glimmer was back in Bow's arms, taking a few pictures of the two, "I think they'll appreciate those in the future." Bow smiled, placing a hand on her shoulder.

"Obviously. I'm gonna get them printed out as a gift. What for, I don't know yet, but I'll think of something! Oh- yes!" The queen giggled as she snapped a perfect shot of Catra lifting Adora up a little higher, the two locking eyes with loving gazes and warm smiles, "Perfect!"

Satisfied, Glimmer teleported to her room to return the trackerpad to her nightstand and return to Bow's side, "I guess if they're busy we could have one more dance?" Bow offered, blushing.

"I'd love to." Glimmer replied, "Only this time, I'm leading."

Bow squeaked as he was abruptly dipped by his girlfriend, eyes widening in surprise. A nervous laugh escaped when he caught eye of the smirk on her face, "Oh boy.."

⚔

Adora had a bright smile on her face when Catra finally placed her back in her wheelchair, "Thank you for that, Catra…"

"Anytime, Adora.." Catra was panting slightly, but it had all been worth it. She carefully wheeled Adora closer to the table before taking a seat on one of the chairs closest to her.

"This has definitely been more fun than I thought it was gonna be."

"Damn well better be. You're a little heavier than you look," Catra teased, smirking as she poked the blonde in the side.

"Hey!" Adora blushed, "I told you you didn't have to do all that…"

Her frown broke Catra immediately, "I'm just messing with you, Adora. I was more than happy to." She assured, kissing her cheek to break her pout into a smile.

Pouting, Adora rested her head on Catra's shoulder, closing her eyes, "I love you…"

"I love you too, princess."

⚔

That night, after Catra had fallen asleep, Adora was sitting propped against a few pillows, journal and pencil in hand.

Today will definitely go down as one of the best in my life. The others decided to throw a party in honor of.. the end of the war, celebrating me and stuff. I honestly wasn't expecting to enjoy myself all that much, all the unwanted attention on me and my screwed up body. Being wheelchair bound isn't exactly a 'heroic' look…

Anyway, Catra asked me to dance after she saw me staring at Bow and Glimmer dancing, and she actually picked me up and held me while waltzing around! I can't believe I managed not to cry. It was such a sweet gesture. I wanna give her something in return. Just saying thank you doesn't feel like enough. I know she says she was happy to do it but I really need her to know just how much that dance, and everything she's been doing to take care of me for that matter, means to me. I just need to figure out what to do or what to give her… I know places I wanna take her and things I wanna do one day, but I can't exactly take her on a tour of Etheria on bedrest. I'm sure I'll think of something eventually.

Her pencil came to a halt when she realized she was basically repeating herself. She glanced over at her sleeping girlfriend, who was curled up against her pillow, Melog cuddled against her. It brought a smile to Adora's face. A thought came to mind.

You know, maybe I should just find something to do for her. She's always appreciated some kind of act over any material gift…

Once I'm able, I'm gonna take her to Our Place, and I'm gonna make her feel as special and loved as she made me feel tonight. I

think a picnic and some music at that place will be perfect. I can't wait!

~ Adora

Satisfied, Adora closed her journal, placing the leather bound book and pencil on her nightstand before finally laying back down. She fell asleep fantasizing about the perfect date she wanted to give the love and light of her life.

Different Types of Therapy

Chapter Summary

> Adora is starting to get back on her feet, and Catra has been working on a special project for restoring Etheria

It had been a month since the fall of Horde Prime, and the beginning of a peaceful era on Etheria. The sounds of birds singing, chirps carried by the gentle breeze outside of the castle was calming and sweet. As of now, the palace was so quiet and relaxing…

and Adora could. Not. Take it. She was *so* bored! She had counted the ceiling tiles twice just this week alone. Ninety six.

She had tried to read, but couldn't focus long enough to comprehend anything unless Catra read it to her. She tried stretching and yoga, and that helped the pain, but it wasn't enough. She wanted to run, she wanted to fly with Swiftwind and do loop-de-loops! Fuck, she just wanted to stand on her own two feet! It had been a month, surely *that* was enough bedrest. She was capable of a few things, she just knew it, and this was the perfect time to do it. She couldn't stand laying around feeling absolutely useless anymore.

Catra was currently in a meeting with the Alliance, discussing rebuilding no doubt, so that gave her time to try and do some healing of her own.

"Okay, Adora… you can do this!" She took a deep breath, sitting up and scooting to the edge of the bed. She looked at her wheelchair and sighed. It would probably be easier to stand up from a proper chair, and not the bed. By now though, she'd mastered sliding in and out of bed with the thing, and easily maneuvered her way into the seat, "That's half the battle…" she assured herself, wheeling herself a little away from the bed, before gripping onto the armrests.

Carefully, she pushed herself up managing to stand on wobbly legs. She smiled: progress! Determined, she slowly took a step forward, and another, then another, then-

then she was on the floor, knees buckled and face first, "Ow…" she grumbled.

"Adora?!"

Catra! On one hand, Adora was relieved she had help, but the other half of her was just embarrassed.

"Adora! Are you okay?!" The magicat shrieked as soon as she opened the door, running over and helping Adora back into her chair, "What happened?" She asked, brushing a hair out of her face.

"I was- I was trying to stand up. *Walk* . I- I'm so tired Catra. I've been stuck here so long.."

Frowning, Catra crouched down in front of the wheelchair, taking her partner's hands, "I understand, and I'm here for you. I- *all* of us are here for you, and you're right, it has been a while, so maybe it's time we start trying to get you on your feet again."

Adora's eyes lit up, "Really..?!"

"Of course, princess. Just this time, let me help you okay?"

Nodding, and finally smiling, Adora leaned back in her chair as Catra wheeled her over closer to the bed.

"Okay, let's stretch your legs out a little bit so they aren't dead asleep this time. I'm willing to bet that's at least half the reason you fell."

Nodding, Adora watched as Catra gently placed a hand on her calf, slowly straightening her left leg out, before bringing it back down. She carefully did it two more times before repeating the process with her other leg, stopping when Adora needed a break.

Afterwards, she started to massage her knees as gently as possible while still being efficient. She took Adora's groans and relaxed smile as a sign she was doing something right. She spent close to five minutes on the massage before stopping, "Feel a little better?"

" *Yes* , you're a miracle worker." Adora mused, opening her eyes and smiling at her.

"Nah, that's all you babe." Catra replied casually, but paused when she saw the look she was being given.

"Catraaaa, I think the Rebellion is turning you soffftt~!" She giggled, but her eyes and smile were radiating how much that meant to her.

"Gahh, shut up, dummy. I didn't say anything," Catra blushed, but smiled as she got to her feet, "Now come on, do you wanna walk or not?"

"Yes!" Adora took Catra's hands once they were offered, taking a deep breath as she was slowly helped to her feet.

"Okay, princess, just take small steps with me. Focus on me…"

Nodding, the blonde held Catra's gaze as they began to cross the room in tiny strides. Adora immediately noticed a difference. The pain was minimal now, and she felt much more stable than she did the first time.

They were across the room in about three minutes, and Adora didn't know what else to do but laugh and cling to Catra in a hug.

⚔

Tears rolled down Adora's cheeks as she barely managed to finish what she was saying, "I… I've been trying so hard to just- relax, do nothing, h-heal? I just- I feel so *useless* ! I can't just- *not* do anything! What kind of a h-hero just does *nothing* while everyone else rebuilds the world?!"

"Adora…" Perfuma quietly prompted, reaching over and taking her friend's hand, "Not all heros have to die to be remembered. You've done so many *amazing* things for the Rebellion and for Etheria the past few years; rest and relaxation are things you've both earned and deserve," She explained, carefully wiping away her friend's tears, "Besides, nobody expects you to just bounce back right after all that went down at the Heart." Adora still hadn't explained exactly *what* all went down at the Heart, but she wasn't going to force it out of her.

"I- I know I… guess I just mostly hate being so still and doing nothing for so long.."

"Well, you're starting to get back on your feet again, so maybe soon you can find something easy that you can help with to ease your consciousness. I actually have a few that have come to mind already."

"Really?" Adora's eyes lit up at the suggestion.

"Well… I would tell you, but the project isn't mine to share. I think she'll tell you about it really soon though, and I know she'll be happy to accept the help."

Though a little disappointed at more waiting, the blonde nodded in understanding, "Alright then…"

"Now," She continued changing the subject, "I see you've brought your journal. Did you have something you wanted to share?"

"Yes, actually!" Adora perked up again, reaching over and grabbing her journal out of her wheelchair. She'd gotten out and sat on a bench for the session. A smile formed as she flipped open to a page and showed her friend and therapist.

On the page was a title reading 'Those I'm Grateful For', with a small list underneath.

Catra (my love)

The Rebellion (my family)

Melog & Swiftwind (emotional support)

Mara (role model)

Razz (parental..?)

"Awe, this is really sweet, Adora!" Perfuma smiled, passing the book back to her, "It's good for you to write things like this down. Have you been using this everyday?"

"Mhm!" Adora smiled a little wider, "Though sometimes it's just a really bad sketch of something.."

"That's okay!" Perfuma chuckled, "Whatever feels right for that day."

Before either blondes could say anything else, Glimmer teleporting into the garden interrupted them, "Guys we-" her eyes widened as she froze, "Shit! I'm *so* sorry did I-"

"It's okay, Glimmer, we're done anyway." Adora promised, "What did you need?"

"Oh! Well, we're having a meeting and I was looking for Perfuma, but you seem to be up and moving around today, if you wanted to join us?"

Adora gasped and nodded, "Please!" She exclaimed, already sliding back into her wheelchair. At Catra's request, she was only walking a little bit each day for a while, until they were sure she wouldn't collapse.

Smiling, Glimmer nodded, "I'll meet you two there!" She said before teleporting away once again.

"Want me to push the wheelchair for you?" Perfuma offered.

"No thanks, I can handle it." Adora replied, before the two started making their way out of the courtyard at Adora's pace.

⚔

When Adora wheeled into the war room, she was surprised to see Catra at the head of the table with Glimmer. Granted, she wasn't sure if Catra had been given a chair of her own yet, but to see her at the head of the table was still a surprise, "What's all this about?" She asked automatically, pulling up to the table next to her chair, where Melog was napping. She smiled and gently petted them behind their ears.

Glimmer hummed, sliding into her chair, "Well, technically, this meeting was called by Catra, so I think I'll just let her do the talking."

Blushing, and groaning softly, Catra cleared her throat, making sure everyone was seated and comfortable before hopping off the arm of Glimmer's chair.

"Okay, so as we've all figured out by now, there are a lot of ex-soldiers who's only home is now in complete shambles."

"I wouldn't say *completely* .. Most of the Frightzone is covered in beautiful greenery now!" Perfuma offered, clasping her hands together.

Catra took a deep breath, "Yes.. but that still isn't a place to live. We decided at the last meeting that the land belongs to Scorpia, since it was originally the Scorpioni Kingdom, and while most of the ex-soldiers will probably live there once reconstruction is finished, they need places to stay until then."

"Plumeria has already started a refugee camp for anyone who needs a place to stay," Perfuma again spoke up, "With help from Bow and my people, the movement is working splendidly!"

"There's a camp that's been started in Theymor as well," Glimmer added, "But as we discussed last time, there's a special group of those from the Frightzone who need a little more attention." The queen smiled, looking back at Catra.

Adora was lost. Well, she understood most of it, but she still felt a headache forming at the realization that her resting didn't stop the work of the Alliance. The world kept on spinning. Decisions affecting the planet had been made and she wasn't there to help…

"-The children that were orphaned and forced to live and work in the Frightzone have no place to go, even once the kingdom is rebuilt. I'd like to build a place for them to stay until a real family can take them in. Sparkles said it was called an orphanage."

"And Bow found an old run down school building right here in Brightmoon for the project! That way Catra can easily access it and be there when she needs to, as she's requested to manage it for the time being."

That caught Adora's attention. She looked up at her partner, so many emotions swirling inside her head. On one hand, she wished she could have been around to help make these choices, and on another she was *so* proud of Catra for what she was doing now all on her own. She looked up just as Catra glanced her way, smiling and ears pinned down.

That's when she realized this was probably what Perfuma had been talking about, "Wow…" she finally spoke up, "That's- so amazing, Catra! I know I still can't do much, but I'd really like to help you with that. I think it's really important to give those kids a loving place to stay that most of us Horde soldiers were denied." Tears welled up in Adora's eyes for the second time that day as she spoke.

"Thank you, Adora," Catra smiled, "And, I'd love your help."

Nodding, Adora felt a lot better. She could finally, *finally* do something! She was going to help, and arguably, would be helping those who needed it most right now.

⚔

It took three weeks of straight work from the Alliance and construction workers to refurbish the old schoolhouse into an orphanage. Catra made sure the bedrooms were filled with comfortable bunk beds, the playroom had plenty of toys and stuffed animals, and that there was even a room dedicated to teaching them things they should have already been taught in school.

The first day the kids were transferred to the building, appropriately named Brightzone Orphanage, was a beautiful sight. The second they learned who was responsible for giving them edible food and comfortable beds, Catra was on the floor surrounded by little kids hugging her and thanking her. It made Adora smile as she watched from her chair a few feet away.

The sound of Catra laughing and gently assuring the kids this was all for them, helping them find clean clothes and picking out a special stuffed animal just for them, it was a side of Catra nobody ever knew existed. Not even the magicat herself.

"That was adorable." The blonde said when her girlfriend finally got the kids to sit down and eat, finding a moment to slip away.

"Shut up, it's the least I could do for them."

"I never knew you had such a nurturing side though," Adora giggled.

"Yeah? Me either.." Catra chuckled, crouching down to kiss Adora gently. The blonde happily returned the embrace, "I'm gonna go say goodbye to the kids for today, then how about we head home and get you on your feet for a few minutes?"

"I'd love that," the princess smiled, blushing when she received a kiss on the cheek.

The goodbyes lasted a little longer than anticipated, but after hugs and promises to return soon, the couple were finally headed back to the castle.

⚔

I never knew Catra had such a sweet side to her. I thought it was so sweet when she decided to open an orphanage for the poor kids that had been kidnapped by the Horde, but the way she interacted with them today…

They all loved her so much, and she was so gentle, and kind, and- and patient! It was amazing! When I told Glimmer she told me she'd have to see it to believe it, and honestly, I can't blame her. I'm so proud of how far she's come in so little time.

I've made some progress myself. I walked on my own for ten minutes this evening after Catra helped me stretch. I'm hoping to be out of this chair soon, I hate the pitied looks I get from everyone outside my immediate circle.

I still have nightmares. I've started trying to train myself to be quiet, so I don't wake Catra. Is it healthy? Probably not.. but she's so busy now, I don't need to keep taking advantage of her taking care of me. I can handle myself!

~ Adora

Two Steps Forward, One Step Back

Chapter Summary

Catra learns what "Sleep fighting" really is and deals with Adora making serious progress on her feet.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Do you have to go?"

"Hey, I'll be back before you wake up tomorrow. I promise," Catra assured, cupping Adora's face as she pressed a kiss to her nose.

Adora whimpered, hugging Catra, "Why can't I go with you..?"

"Because you still need to rest and rocky Frightzone terrain isn't good for you right now. It's just a few hours."

"Mm.."

Catra and Glimmer were heading to the Frightzone to pick up some kids that had been in hiding. Scorpia had found nearly twenty of them earlier that day, and Catra wanted to make sure they got settled in at Brightzone.

"I love you, Adora."

"I love you too.." Adora mumbled, curling up against her girlfriend, not wanting to let her get out of the bed to leave.

"I need to get up now…" Catra whispered to the blonde, feeling her arms tighten around her.

"Okay…" Adora whimpered, pouting as she curled up against Catra's now vacant pillow.

"You took your medicine right?"

"Mhm…"

"Then you should sleep like a baby," The magicat teased, leaning down for a final kiss before grabbing her jacket and slipping it on. She made sure Adora was covered up and comfortable before turning to Melog, "Keep an eye on her, okay bud?"

Meowing, Melog hopped onto the bed and curled up around Adora, who relaxed a little. Satisfied, Catra finally grabbed her trackerpad before finally leaving the room for the mission.

⚔

Adora's eyes widened, watching in horror at the dying planet around her. Gone was the beautiful planet of Etheria. All that was left was ashes and ruins of what had once been before Prime destroyed it. She had failed. She had lost the war.

As she turned around to survey the area, however, she was greeted with a sight that brought her heart to her stomach, "Catra!!"

The magicat was on the ground in a dark puddle, unmoving and painfully still. Unfortunately, before she could take two steps forward, her arms were seized by Prime himself, "I believe you've done enough damage, haven't you?"

"N-No! This is your fault! You did this you-!" Tears running down her face, Adora screamed and started to try and fight the tyrant, all fruitless by her bound arms.

"Do not fear, She-Ra. I still have great plans for you."

…

Catra immediately knew something was wrong the second she entered the castle, only to find Melog waiting, meowing in distress.

Glimmer frowned, "You should probably-"

"Already on it, Sparkles. Goodnight!" She called quickly, before racing down the hallway after her alien companion, making it to their bedroom in just a few minutes.

"Adora?" Catra called gently, pushing the door open, and finding her girlfriend tossing and turning, fighting something (or someone) in her sleep. She was whimpering with furrowed eyebrows and tear stained cheeks, "Oh…" Ears pinning against her head, the brunette rushed to the bedside, biting her lip. Carefully, she reached out and placed a light hold on Adora's shoulder, "Adora… it's okay, it's just a dream…"

Worry bloomed further in her chest when Adora immediately recoiled from the touch, whining and almost screaming as she fought to get away from- Prime? Shadow Weaver?

…Her?

Shaking off *that* trail of thought, Catra took a deep breath, before trying again, "Adora." She said, louder, "Come on baby, wake up, it's not real." She tried, shaking her lightly.

While that did technically wake her after a few more shakes and calls, Catra hated that her partner woke up screaming, jolting upright and fighting for a breath through her tears, "Adora! Adora, it's okay!" Catra said.

Upon hearing her girlfriend, Adora turned and all but flung herself onto the magicat, "C-Catra!"

"Shhh, I'm here, it's okay.." Catra assured, sliding into bed and wrapping her arms more securely around the blonde, "You're safe, I'm here…" She continued the comforting mantra, rubbing her back and running her fingers through her hair until her sobs reduced to whimpers and light tremors.

".. Do you wanna talk about it?"

Adora shook her head, remaining silent for three more minutes before relenting, "Prime… he destroyed Etheria he… he- killed everyone… except me. He kept me, he t-tortured me, he…" another sob escaped, "I was so scared… I thought- I thought you…"

"Well, I'm not. I'm here, we're all here, baby. It's just a nightmare…"

"I- I know… just.."

"I know…"

Silence reigned once more, Adora simply taking refuge in the secure embrace of her partner and the calming effect her purring had on her.

"Catra..?" She finally asked.

"Yes?"

The moment Catra looked down at her, Adora brought their lips together, gripping onto the collar of her shirt.

"I missed you… so much. I need you…"

"I'm here Adora… you can relax. Tomorrow I'm home all day."

Finally smiling, Adora nodded and snuggled in close, letting Catra spoon her, "Yay…"

"Feeling like you can get back to sleep?"

"Mhm.." The blonde yawned.

Nodding, Catra held her partner close, "Goodnight, princess."

⚔

When Catra woke to an empty bed, her first thought was panic. She shot out of bed, screaming Adora's name.. only to find her at her desk twenty feet away.

"Are you okay..?" Adora raised an eyebrow, looking up at the magicat as she quickly approached.

"I'm sorry I just- you haven't been out of bed first like- ever since I got here.."

"It's alright, I'm sorry. I should have said something or- woke you- I don't know.."

"What are you doing anyway?"

"Oh!" Adora blushed, turning toward her desk once more, where half made maps, charts, and a few books scattered the surface, "I've kinda gotten into cartography and star charts. It keeps my mind busy and- Etheria is changing and stars are so new.."

"That's cute, you dork," Catra teased, kissing the top of her head, "I'm happy you found a new hobby."

"Well, until I'm okay enough to actually explore space and Etheria, this is as close as I can get."

Catra frowned. She was so happy and proud of the progress Adora had made the past couple months, but part of her was now so used to protecting and caring for Adora. She was scared of something happening to her again. What if next time she didn't come back? What if she was taken away forever?!

Deep breaths, Catra.

"Catra?"

"Huh?"

"I asked you if you were okay.. You spaced out."

"Yeah, I'm good. I just- remembered I have therapy this morning; I should probably get ready."

"Oh, yeah! You definitely should." Adora hummed, leaning up to kiss her gently before turning back to her charts and map, "I love you."

"I love you too, princess." Catra gave her shoulder a gentle squeeze, "When I get back, do you wanna maybe show me your map progress? Maybe read together?"

"Sounds perfect!" Adora smiled a little more, "I can't wait."

"Me either."

⚔

"...and I know it's not healthy but I'm terrified of letting her out of my sight if I know she isn't safe in our room."

Perfuma took a moment to process everything she had just heard. Catra had spent the last half hour ranting about her fears of Adora becoming more mobile again, and how she had extreme mixes of emotions regarding the fact.

"Well, first off, I'm very proud of you for being open and honest with both me and yourself about this. Your possessiveness and fears are completely valid. You've poured your being into making sure she recovers properly and is safe, but we both know she's a very mobile person."

"I know she is and I'm not trying to-"

Holding up a hand to halt the magicat, Perfuma shook her head, "I know you don't want to hold her back or force anything on her, so what you need to do here is talk to Adora about your fears. Tell her everything you told me, and talk to her about it."

"She's just gonna say she's fine and not to worry!"

"I think you might find yourself surprised. She's gotten very good at expressing her own emotions with me, and once you do so with her, I believe it'll prompt her to realize it's okay, and necessary, for her to do the same."

"And what if it doesn't?"

"Then you make it clear you need more than to brush the topic off, though I doubt it'll be necessary."

"Okay.." Catra took a deep breath, her shaky hand gently combing through Melog's mane, the alien napping in her lap with a soft purr emitting from their chest, "What do I do after we talk?"

"I don't think I need to answer that, or even can. It really depends on how the conversation goes and where you two will go from there. It's important for you both to come to decisions like that together. Though I guess I would recommend at the very least you make sure she doesn't try to hide in bed or stop working on her physical therapy just to please you, or think she is anyway."

The magicat nodded, "Yeah, of course. I would never want her to do that."

"I know."

"Maybe… maybe I should bring her out of the castle for this, just to emphasize that?"

Perfuma smiled, "That sounds wonderful."

"Okay… I think.. I think I wanna do that now."

"Alright, I think that'll be good for you. If you two feel like you'd both like to talk to me together after I am completely okay with it."

"Thanks, Perfuma." Both women got to her feet, Catra surprising the latter with a brief hug.

"Of course," Perfuma smiled, returning the embrace before allowing the magicat to make her way out of the library and back to Adora.

⚔

Adora smiled when she heard Catra enter the room behind her, but frowned when she turned to see her ears pinned and her arm covering her chest, "What's wrong..?"

"Nothing- well, okay, I really need to talk to you about something."

Adora felt her heart drop, and found herself immediately tearing up and trembling, "D-Did I do something? I- I'm sorry I didn't-!"

Catra's eyes widened, "Oh, princess no!" She rushed to crouch in front of the wheelchair, pulling Adora into a secure embrace, "No no no, that is *not* what I meant baby.."

Whimpering, Adora clung to the magicat, a few tears running down her face, "T-Then..?"

"Come on, I want to go for a little stroll outside, it's gonna be alright."

"Okay…" Adora sniffed, wiping her eyes before slowly getting to her feet. She took Catra's hand and the two slowly departed from the room, making their way out to the garden.

It only took a few minutes before they found a seat underneath a tree, Adora resting her head on Catra's chest, "So what did you wanna talk about..?"

"First, I want you to know that you aren't doing anything wrong, and I'm so so proud of you."

"Okay…?"

"Just- lately, as you've been recovering, my- my.." She had to take a deep breath before she could will herself to continue, "My possessiveness is growing over you because I'm so used to taking care of you now. I'm scared of knowing you're anywhere but safe in our room, I'm scared of the possibility of you being somewhere potentially dangerous where you could be taken away from me again… but at the same time I want to see you get better and do whatever it is that makes you happy, whether it involves me or not.."

"Oh, Catra.." Adora sat up, cupping her face and gently resting their foreheads together, "I'm never leaving you alone again, I love you… I'm really proud of you for telling me how you feel though. If it makes you feel any better, I've felt really good the last few days, but I don't really want to go out and do anything unless you're with me yet either. I want to sometime soon, but currently I'm really happy with the idea of helping out at Brightzone and working on my maps and stuff at home."

"I like that… and I like the thought of going to space and exploring other worlds and stuff with you too. I heard Entrapta

has been toying with the ship and making upgrades with Hordak."

The mention of Darla made Adora's eyes light up, "I can't wait to see it."

Catra hummed, running her fingers through the blonde hair resting over Adora's shoulder, "I love you…"

"I love you too," Adora giggled, blushing when she was suddenly fully pulled into Catra's lap.

"I still can't believe this is real.." Catra whispered after a few minutes of silence.

"What..?"

"That I get to hold you and love you so openly now, that I don't have to worry about anything.."

"Me too… I can't even begin to describe how miserable I was without you all those years…"

"Me too…" Catra sighed, smiling as she began to purr, "But it's over now, and I believe you wanted to show me some of your

cartography work?"

Eyes lighting up, Adora nodded, getting up to head back in, only for Catra to scoop her into her arms, "Catra!" She squealed, laughing.

"Yes, princess?" She smirked.

"What are you doing?"

"What does it look like? Capturing a princess~"

"Ah, well I guess the great She-Ra needs to surrender." Adora giggled.

"Yes she does~" The brunette laughed, kissing her forehead as she carried Adora back into the palace and up to their bedroom.

Chapter End Notes

This is the last chapter before a time skip! Next chapter will take place a year ahead of the end of the series. I can't wait!

A Year of Recovery

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The past year had been a roller coaster for Etheria. Rebuilding in the Scorpioni kingdom had been advancing well, as well as reconstruction in kingdoms like Salineas and Dryl.

Recovery time for Adora had been extensive. The castle physician didn't clear her officially to be wheelchair free until six months after the war, and even then her leg occasionally bothered her, causing a small limp on her worst days. Still though, with help and love from her girlfriend and friends, progress was bearable and she was able to get back on her feet.

Nowadays, she was doing a lot of stargazing and cartography, as well as some diplomatic missions both on and off the planet.

Currently though, Adora was sitting at her desk, going over one of her newest maps, when she heard a thump behind her. Upon turning around, she saw Melog pawing at a leather bound book on the floor, "Is that my journal?" She asked, a lopsided smile on her face as she stood and approached the alien feline, who meowed and nudged it with their nose towards her.

"I know I haven't used it in a few months, but I haven't needed it." Adora said, lifting the book up and casually flipped through the pages, until she noticed a small bookmark sticking out of one of the older entries, "Huh."

Once she turned to the page, she slowly took a seat on the side of the bed to read it.

Today will definitely go down as one of the best in my life. The others decided to throw a party in honor of.. the end of the war, celebrating me and stuff. I honestly wasn't expecting to enjoy myself all that much, all the unwanted attention on me and my screwed up body. Being wheelchair bound isn't exactly a 'heroic' look…

Anyway, Catra asked me to dance after she saw me staring at Bow and Glimmer dancing, and she actually picked me up and held me while waltzing around! I can't believe I managed not to cry. It was such a sweet gesture. I wanna give her something in return. Just saying thank you doesn't feel like enough. I know she says she was happy to do it but I really need her to know just how much that dance, and everything she's been doing to take care of me for that matter, means to me. I just need to figure out what to do or what to give her… I know places I wanna take her and things I wanna do one day, but I can't exactly take her on a tour of Etheria on bedrest. I'm sure I'll think of something eventually.

You know, maybe I should just find something to do for her. She's always appreciated some kind of act over any material gift…

Once I'm able, I'm gonna take her to Our Place, and I'm gonna make her feel as special and loved as she made me feel tonight. I

think a picnic and some music at that place will be perfect. I can't wait!

~ Adora

A smile formed on her face as she reached the end of the entry. She'd completely forgotten about the picnic she'd wanted to take Catra on, and now she could!

"You know Melog, I think this date might be the perfect time, given it's almost our one year anniversary."

Meowing in approval, the feline leapt onto the bed and nuzzled her arm, purring. Adora giggled and set the journal back on her nightstand before petting them gently behind the ears.

"Adora!"

The princess looked up just as Catra walked into the room, a decent sized box in her hands, "What is that?" She laughed, getting up and approaching to take the box from her partner and set it on the bed.

"Delivery from the tailor shop. Remember last week when we spent four hours picking out some new stuff?"

Adora groaned at the reminder, "Right. Alright, what do we got?" She sighed, opening the box and peering inside.

It was immediately obvious was belonged to Catra, whether it was because it was stirrup leggings, black and red themed, or just three sizes smaller, Adora knew. "Awe this is cute, Catra!" She cooed, lifting a body suit similar to the first one Entrapta had made her on Darla out of the box. The biggest difference was that the top piece was now white with a gold collar and belt. Her leggings were still black, as most pairs she got were.

"Yeah well, I'm just- letting everyone know She-Ra is taken.." Catra admitted, blushing.

"Awe!" Adora set the outfit down and lifted Catra into her arms, "You're cute." She giggled, kissing her nose.

"Gah! Adora!" The brunette squealed, "Stop it!"

"You know you love me~" she teased, finally setting her on her feet.

Catra rolled her eyes fondly, sticking her tongue out at her before noticing something, "Hey Adora? Where is your wing pin thing? It's not on your belt."

The blonde looked down, and saw it indeed was missing, "Yeah, I-think I lost it a few days ago, I'm still looking for it."

"Oh.. I'm sorry, I know it means a lot to you." Catra frowned, taking Adora's hand.

"It'll be okay, I'm sure it's just buried on my desk somewhere. I'll find it."

That surprised Catra. Adora never lost anything, least nothing as important to her as her pin. And if she did, Catra couldn't imagine her being this call about it. It was…weird, "Well, I hope you find it."

"I will," Adora promised, before turning her attention back to the box, "I still can't believe I've been forced to change my wardrobe. My jacket is fine."

"It's falling apart and you practically live in that stupid Horde compression top. It's been four years, it's time for a change."

"Fineeee.." Adora skimmed through the box, finding a red top she'd gotten that had half sleeves and the collar trimmed in gold and smiled slightly, "Alright, alright. I'll try this all on and find something, because I was actually hoping to take you out tonight."

Catra's ears perked up, "Where?"

"That's a surprise; you don't have to wear anything super formal, just a little nice."

"Okay… when are we leaving?" Catra smiled; it had been a few weeks since their last date night, though she had been the one to plan it.

"In a few hours." Adora hummed, kissing her cheek after picking up the rest of her clothes from the box.

"That gives me plenty of time then. I was hoping to stop by Brightzone."

"Awe, of course!" Adora nodded, "Take your time, we can go when you get home."

"Alright, I'll see you soon." Catra promised, hugging Adora before she left for the orphanage.

⚔

Catra couldn't help but smile as she walked through the doors of Brightzone Orphanage. She only made it three steps into the

building before a plethora of "Catra!!"s echoed in her ears and she was surrounded by kids hugging her legs.

"Hey, guys," Catra chuckled, smiling as she crouched down with them, "How's everyone doing?"

"Pwincess Scorpia and Perfumma brought us toys today!" One little girl, Jessie exclaimed. She was around six if Catra remembered correctly.

She gave a little gasp and smiled, "They did? That was so nice of them!"

"We gots new stuffies!" A three year old, Fèlix, squealed, holding up a pink bear plushie.

"That's so sweet, Fèlix. Have you given this one a name yet?" Catra asked, ruffling their hair. She wound up sitting on the floor when Fèlix crawled into her lap.

"Ya! I named him Wisp!"

"I think that's a perfect name, bud." Catra chuckled, squeezing them in a small hug.

"Thank yous!"

"I gots a horsey I named Jade!" Jessie chirped, grabbing a purple and turquoise plush off the floor a few feet away.

"Do yous have a animals friend?" Fèlix asked, looking up at Catra.

"I do, actually. Their name is Melog. They're part cat just like me."

All the kids gasped, "Can we meet them?!" Jessie asked.

"Sure, I'll bring them next time I come, okay?"

The small group of kids squealed in delight, hugging her or clapping with excitement.

"For now though, how about we all head to the other room and get comfy on all the couches and chairs? I brought a new story for you all."

Excitement flooded the kids again as they all hurried to get up and find a spot. Well, except for Fèlix, who clung to Catra as she carried them, walking behind the other kids.

⚔

By the time Catra finished reading the story she had brought, most of the kids had fallen asleep, and once Catra made sure everyone was comfortable and safe, she made her way back to the castle, excitement brewing in her chest for her upcoming date.

When she opened the door to their bedroom, she smiled when she was met with Adora wearing her new red top with gray pants and golden sandals to match, "Well don't you look handsome." Catra giggled, approaching and hugging the blonde.

"Thank you," Adora smiled, blushing as she held Catra close, "Do you wanna change before we leave?"

"Yeah, I think Fèlix drooled on me." She laughed, kissing Adora's nose before pulling away to make her way to the dresser.

"The kids are definitely comfortable around you. I'm really proud of you, Catra."

"I try." The brunette hummed, pulling out the body suit Adora complimented earlier. She only took a few minutes in the bathroom to change and run a comb through her shoulder length

hair a few times before she was heading out with Adora to catch a ride with Swiftwind.

⚔

"Why do I need to close my eyes?" Catra pouted as she pressed herself against Adora's back.

"Because I want it to be a surprise. I've had this plan for a long time."

"How long is a long time?"

"Don't worry about that." Adora hummed, smiling when Swiftwind landed, "Thanks Swifty. Can you pick us up in say, two hours?"

"Sure thing, Adora!" He exclaimed, letting Adora help Catra down before nuzzling her cheek and flying off.

"Can I open my eyes now?"

"Yes."

Upon opening her eyes, Catra gasped, smiling the moment she realized where they were, "Our Place..?" She looked up at the blonde, who giggled and nodded.

"Yeah, I thought a picnic up here would be perfect. It's been a while since we had time to be here."

Catra couldn't keep the smile off her face as she took a step forward, seeing the platform that was now covered in landscape, and a blanket with a picnic spread laid out. Still though, it was undoubtedly the special place the couple escaped to all of their childhood when they wanted or needed privacy.

"This is so beautiful… thank you, Adora…" Catra breathed, blinking a few times as the two lowered onto the blanket together.

"You deserve a nice night out. You've been so busy the last few weeks." Adora praised, wrapping her arms around her, "And you have gone above and beyond for me in my recovery. This is the least I could do for you."

Catra wasn't sure how to respond to that. She simply nodded, blinking again as she nuzzled into Adora's shoulder.

The couple eventually opened the basket Adora had had Glimmer bring, snacking on the fruits and sandwiches packed inside, along with some water bottles they had.

"This is amazing…" Catra whispered, resting her head against Adora's chest after they finished eating and had fallen into a cuddle session.

"I'm happy I finally got to be the one taking you out." Adora chuckled, "I.. I actually have a gift for you."

That caught Catra's attention. She sat up, looking back at her girlfriend, "Oh..?"

Adora shifted, sitting up straighter and gently taking Catra's hand, "I just.. I love you so, so much, and I will never be able to express how thankful I am to have you in my life and for everything you've done for me in just the last year alone." Slowly, she reached into her pocket and pulled out her golden pin, "I wanted to give you this to represent a sort of promise ring. Glimmer told me it's like- a step before engagement and marriage. You said you wanted people to know She-Ra is taken. Well, I want people to know that She-Ra is taken by you."

Tears ran down Catra's face as Adora clipped the golden pin to her top. She threw her arms around Adora and kissed her passionately, "I love you too!"

Adora laughed, holding her close, "I'm sorry I lied about losing my pin, I just wanted it to be a surprise."

"It's okay," Catra snorted, curling up against the blonde.

"I couldn't think of a better place to give this to you."

"I'll wear it everyday." The magicat promised, squeezing Adora's hand.

They spent another half hour together just resting in the blissful bubble of each other until Swiftwind arrived to fly them home for a night of sweet passion they'd been holding back the entire ride home.

Chapter End Notes

I am so happy with this chapter! Much fluff and love and it can only go fluffier from here! For the most part anyway :)

A Place to Call Home

Chapter Summary

> Catra doesn't feel at home at Brightmoon anymore, but Adora knows just what to do.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Ever since Catra received the pin two weeks ago, she made sure to show it off on everything she wore. There were very few possessions in her life that she was proud of and felt were truly *hers* . Her mask, which was now somewhere floating on the Velvet Glove, her whip, which was tainted by Shadow Weaver hurting her with it, and now she had Adora's pin. The blonde had once told her it was the first item she'd found after joining the Rebellion that she chose for herself, that she picked to stand out and express herself. A smile tugged at the magicat's lips when she remembered the night after she'd gotten it, when Adora had said that giving her the pin was like giving her a piece of herself. She felt honored to be trusted with that.

Adora had always been her home, even when they were enemies. In their time separated, Catra had felt so lost, like she was living in a state of displacement. She didn't feel safe anywhere, because Adora hadn't been with her. Now she had Adora back, but sometimes something still didn't feel right. Sure, living in Brightmoon was great, but it wasn't what she really wanted. She wanted a space just for her and Adora, where they could escape the sparkles and bright pink when they needed to. Sure, it had been a year now, but there was still an occasional glare from a guard or flashback to a battle against the people that she now called her friends that sent her down a trail of thought she didn't want to travel again. The only problem was that she'd yet to find

the courage to tell Adora about it. She'd been living here for almost five years now, and she didn't want to uproot her from the first place she'd ever truly felt at home in.

" *Everything okay, kit?* "

Catra jumped, looking at Melog leapt onto the bed and sitting next to her, purring when the brunette gave them scratches behind their ears, "Everything's fine, Melog. I'm just…homesick?"

" *But you live here?* "

"I know but.. I grew up with Adora being my only home and.. I miss having that space where I don't have to worry about us being interrupted."

Melog mewled, nuzzling Catra's cheek, " *Does this have anything to do with your new royal advisor position?* "

Catra sighed, "Maybe a little. Living in the Frightzone made sure that 'work' and 'home' couldn't be separated. Now that I'm working and not just living here… yeah."

" *Have you talked to your mate?* "

Her ears pinned to her head, "No…"

" *And how long have you felt this way?* "

Unable to respond, Catra simply laid down and curled up against her companion, whimpering.

"Catra?"

The sound of Adora's voice sent a flood of warmth to Catra's chest. She rolled over to see the blonde closing the door, then crossing the room to the bedside.

"Is everything okay?"

"Ye-... No.. not really."

"What's the matter?" Adora frowned, taking a seat next to the magicat.

"I.. I don't.." Catra rolled onto her back to look up at her girlfriend, "I don't wanna keep living in Brightmoon…"

Adora wasn't sure what to make of that. The idea of Catra leaving absolutely terrified her, but she wouldn't leave without her, right? Catra had been adjusting so well to the Rebellion though… at least that's what Adora had thought.

"W-Why? Did something happen? I don't.. I don't understand.."

"It's not that something happened I just.. I want home to be a separate place from work, and a place where it can be just us… but I don't wanna make you uproot from a place you've called home for years now.."

"Oh, love…" Adora laid on her side, wrapping her arms around Catra and pulling her into a secure hug, "Nowhere is home to me if you aren't there with me.."

Ears pinning to her head, Catra buried her face into Adora's shirt, "... I love you, idiot."

"I love you too, and you know what, I think I know the perfect place to build us a home."

Catra's eyes dilated, "Really?"

"Mhm. There's a beautiful clearing in the Whispering Woods where I think we can build a perfect cabin or cottage for us. The woods will protect us and hide us when we want to be alone."

Purring, Catra nodded, "How would we build it?"

"I'll enlist some workers from Brightmoon, as well as help build it myself. The hardest part is gonna be telling Glimmer and Bow."

"Yeah.." Catra frowned.

Noticing, Adora cupped the brunette's face, "This is something I want just as much as you do, okay? I promise."

Nodding, Catra clung to her, closing her eyes as she imagined what was to come.

⚔

"You're *what* ?!" Glimmer gaped at the sheepish couple standing in front of her.

"We just need some personal space Glimmer. No offense to your… surprise teleports." Adora blushed furiously at the flustering memories.

"I know, I know, I get it, it's just a lot. When are you-?"

"We're going to have a home build in a clearing I've found in the woods," Adora explained, "It's not like we won't see each other all the time, it's just important to both me and Catra that we have a space that's just ours, not connected to work or anything else."

"We understand, Adora. You don't have to explain that to us," Bow smiled, gently hugging the couple.

"Thanks, Bow.." Catra smiled, purring quietly.

"Do you have any plans drawn or in mind?" Glimmer asked, bringing a smile to Adora's face.

"Not drawn but… I have some ideas."

⚔

The following six months were a fever dream for Catra and Adora. When they weren't at the orphanage or the Scorpioni kingdom, they were overseeing the construction of their home.

With She-Ra's help, any heavy lifting was done with ease, and Adora was always there to do any other building and learning she could. Catra was kept away from a lot of the actual construction, as Adora wanted to surprise her with the final product, though the

two made all final choices interior wise together before Adora took them to their builders.

A few days after the house was complete and Adora was ready to bring Catra though, she was a nervous wreck, pacing back and forth in Bow and Glimmer's bedroom.

"Adora, you've spent all this time *literally* building a house together, calm down." Glimmer scoffed, crossing her arms playfully.

"I know, I know, but I'm just scared she won't be ready, but I really want this to be our first memory there and for it to be good and-"

"Adora! Adora, breathe," Bow interrupted, placing his hands on her shoulders, "It's okay. I have very little doubt she'll say no, but no matter what, you two are inseparable, okay?"

Nodding, the blonde slumped into her friend's arms for a moment, taking a deep breath, "Okay… okay."

"Feel better?"

"Mhm. I love you guys." Adora smiled, pulling both of her friends into a hug, "We'll call you guys over for a house tour soon, promise."

"You better. We love you too." Glimmer hummed, the hug finally separating as the blonde left to find her girlfriend.

⚔

Catra could barely contain her excitement as she clung to Adora, "Are we almost thereee?" It almost pushed down her nausea from the flight. Almost.

"Yes, love, I promise!" Adora chuckled, "Swifty knows the way."

"As any noble steed would!" Swiftwind exclaimed.

"No loops!" Catra yelled. Her fear of heights and the mini Melog that was hiding in her satchel were not the optimal situation for this horse to literally flip on her.

"He won't Catra, I made him promise not to," Adora laughed, smiling when she felt Catra tighten her hold around her waist, "Are you okay?"

"I will be once we're on the ground!"

"Alright, alright, I'm landing!" Swiftwind scoffed before descending into the woods and landing in the clearing.

Catra giggled when Adora lifted her by her hips off of Swiftwind and placed her on her feet. She kissed her cheek before turning, gasping when she saw their new home, "Oh, Adora…"

The cottage was a beautiful, craftsman style home with a wrap around porch. Vines and ivy covered the roof and walls, bushes and flowers surrounding the foundation. Stairs were on both ends of the porch, the one on the side of the cottage leading to a stable for Swiftwind.

Melog almost immediately jumped out of Catra's satchel, growing back to their normal size to run around the yard.

"What do you think?" Adora smiled. She gasped when Catra suddenly tackled her in a hug, tears running down her face.

"I love it so much..! Thank you!" The brunette attacked Adora with kisses of appreciation, "I love you!"

"I love you too!" Adora laughed, wrapping her arms around her waist, "You haven't even seen the inside yet, silly."

"I helped pick out most of the furniture though, the outside is what you kept me in the dark about."

"I know, I know." The blonde hummed, slowly getting to her feet, "Before we go inside though, I wanted to talk to you."

"What about?" Catra asked, looking up at her partner, who was now blushing a brilliant shade of red. She gently took Catra's hands in her own.

"I just… I wanted to tell you how much I love you. I love you so much, Catra. You mean more to me than I will ever be able to express through words. You've been there for me through my childhood, through the end of the war, and through my rough road of recovery. Because of you, I have a perfect, beautiful family I would move the universe for," Catra's eyes widened as the blonde slowly lowered to one knee, pulling a box out of her pocket to reveal a brilliant golden band inside, "Now we have a beautiful new home, and I want to make our first memory here special. Let me promise to do the same, and make our promise to be together forever official. Will you marry me?"

Tears ran down Catra's face as she stared at the ring. The moment her shock wore off a huge smile spread across her face, "I- Of course I will, you dummy!" She allowed Adora to slip the ring on her finger and get to her feet before crashing their lips together.

Both women were crying when they slowly pulled apart from their kiss, before letting their foreheads rest against each other's, "I don't know what I'd do without you…" Catra whispered, smiling when they intertwined their fingers and she could feel the band of her ring between them.

"You won't have to find out, kitten." Adora replied, just as quiet. Her tone sent shivers down Catra's spine.

"Kitten..?" She squeaked, blushing.

"Is that okay?"

"Mhm..!" Catra blushed, burying her face against Adora's shoulder, "Can we go inside now?"

"Of course, love." Adora chuckled, lifting Catra bridal style before carrying her inside for a very special house warming gift.

Chapter End Notes

OKAY, so yes this is the end of this part, BUT that's because where I wanted to take this AU next feels better if I split this off into multiple books. So now I am going to pick a new day for updates, and I hope you're all just as excited for the beginning of the sequel "Legacy"!

End Notes

I plan to update this fic weekly if possible, so I hope you enjoy! This has been in the works for literal months, and I want to get it finished and posted so I can move on to other aus of mine I am so excited to share.

Also the rating IS subject to change, depending on what I write for it in the future! ***

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!